

Burkina

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** August 4, 1984 **Usage:** National and Civil

Red, yellow, and green are pan-African colors



Red recalls the 1984 revolution

The star is the guiding light of the revolution

Green represents Burkina's abundant natural resources

Africa



Burkina, originally known as Upper Volta, was once a French colony. It became self-governing in 1958 and fully independent in 1960.

The original flag of Upper Volta, adopted at independence, contained three horizontal stripes of black, white, and red. These simple colors represented the three major tributaries of the Volta River, which flow south through the country.

A NEW NATIONAL FLAG

In August 1984 there was a coup and a new flag and emblem were adopted. The new flag is in the pan-African colors, reflecting both a break with the country's colonial past and its unity with other African ex-colonies. The red is also said to symbolize the revolution and the green the abundance of natural riches. The yellow star placed over

the red and green stripes is the guiding light of the revolution.

THE NATIONAL ARMS

The coat of arms, which was adopted in September 1997, shows a shield in the colors of the national flag. The arms are held by two horses, which represent the nobility of the people. Two crossed lances show the will of the people to defend their country, and an open book and two ears of millet symbolize their will to educate and feed themselves. At the top of the arms is a scroll, inscribed with the name Burkina Faso—the country of the upright people. At the base, another scroll carries the national motto: Unity, Development, Justice.